

7-0 (A)

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS

SIGHT RECORD FORM

RESULTS: _____

Rec'd 12/21/00 wpl

SPECIES: YELLOW-THROATED VIREO
(COMMON NAME)Vireo flavifrons
(SCIENTIFIC NAME)

DATE(S) OF OCCURRENCE: 4 May 2000 DATE OF THIS OBSERVATION: 4 May 2000

NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: unknown PLUMAGE: adult

EXACT LOCATION: Rocky Ford State Wildlife Area

COUNTY: Otero

NEAREST TOWN: Rocky Ford

ELEVATION: approx. 4,200 ft.

LENGTH OF OBSERVATION: approx. 5 min. total TIME(S) OF OBSERVATION: approx. 6:00 am

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO SAW AND INDEPENDENTLY IDENTIFIED THE BIRD(S): None that I know of.

WEATHER & LIGHT CONDITIONS [QUALITY; DIRECTION RELATIVE TO BIRD(S); POSITION]:

Weather was clear, warm, and calm. Viewing conditions were excellent in the early morning light.

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT USED:

Bushnell 10x binoculars

DISTANCE FROM BIRD (ESTIMATED UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED): As close as 15 ft.

WAS THE BIRD PHOTOGRAPHED? No IF SO, HAVE YOU SUBMITTED PHOTOGRAPHS?

WHO TOOK THE PHOTOGRAPHS?

GENERAL AND SPECIFIC HABITAT IN WHICH THE BIRD(S) OCCURRED:

Riparian woodland along the Arkansas River. The vireo was in the trees along the edge of the wooded area near the pond at the west end of the SWA.

BEHAVIOR (FLYING; FEEDING; HABITS; BEHAVIORS USED IN IDENTIFYING THE SPECIES OR IN SUPPORTING THE IDENTIFICATION):

The vireo was leisurely foraging for insects at mid to low level in the trees while I watched it. The bird did not call or sing during the observation period.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE BIRD(S) [INCLUDE OVERALL SIZE AND SHAPE; PLUMAGE DETAILS INCLUDING HEAD, THROAT, UNDERSIDES, NAPE, BACK, WINGS, AND TAIL; AND COLOR AND SHAPE OF BILL, LEGS, EYE, ETC. THAT WERE IMPORTANT IN MAKING THE IDENTIFICATION. GIVE PARTICULAR EMPHASIS TO MARKS USED TO IDENTIFY THE BIRD(S)].

This was a small, plump warbler-sized bird (est. 5 or 6 inches long). It had a bright yellow throat and breast and bright yellow "spectacles" around dark eyes and forward to the base of the upper mandible. The bill was a typical relatively stout "vireo" bill and was blackish in color. The bird's belly and undertail coverts were clear white. The throat, breast, belly, and undertail coverts were unstreaked. The head and back were olive (with a yellow tint) becoming gray toward the rump. The head, back, and rump were unstreaked. The tail was relatively short; the upper surface of the tail appeared to be dark gray to blackish. The folded wings were dark slate gray and there were two prominent white wing bars on each wing.

SIMILAR SPECIES AND HOW THEY WERE ELIMINATED:

Species most likely to be confused with Yellow-throated Vireo are Pine Warbler and Yellow-breasted Chat.

Pine Warbler: This species can be eliminated by the observed bird's combination of very bright yellow spectacles, throat, and breast; the typical "vireo" bill; the contrasting gray rump; the lack of white in the outer tail feathers; and the lack of even faint streaking on the breast and flanks.

Yellow-breasted Chat: This species can be eliminated by the yellow (not white) spectacles, the light gray rump contrasting with the olive back and blackish tail, and the presence of white wingbars. The Chat is also a significantly larger species (7.5 in. vs. 5.5 in for Yellow-throated Vireo)

Other "spectacled" vireos can be eliminated by the combination of dark eye, bright yellow spectacles, throat, and breast with white belly and undertail coverts, and the olive head and back with a gray rump on the observed bird.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILAR SPECIES:

This was the fourth Yellow-throated Vireo I have seen in Colorado. I have also seen them in other states (SC, TX, etc.). I also have considerable experience with all the similar species.

BOOKS, GUIDES, RECORDINGS, OR OTHER SOURCES CONSULTED AND HOW THESE INFLUENCED IDENTIFICATION (DURING AND AFTER OBSERVATION):

No field guide was used or needed at the time of observation . This is a very distinctive bird when seen well.

THIS REPORT WAS MADE FROM NOTES MADE DURING _____ OR AFTER X OBSERVATION, OR LATER FROM MEMORY _____

DATE OF THIS WRITTEN REPORT: May 9, 2000

REPORTING OBSERVER: Dick Schottler

SIGNATURE:



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